

When analyzing multiple outcomes separately, **group your results section by outcome** rather than by analysis type. This organization improves clarity and readability by keeping all information about each outcome together.

Why group by outcome

Grouping by outcome helps readers:

- Follow the story of each outcome from descriptive statistics through final results
- Compare findings across outcomes more easily
- Understand the complete picture for each outcome before moving to the next
- Navigate directly to outcomes of interest

How to organize by outcome

For each outcome, present:

1. Descriptive statistics
2. Main analysis results
3. Sensitivity analyses
4. Subgroup analyses (if applicable)

Structure:

Results

Outcome 1: Mortality

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

Outcome 2: Hospital readmission

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

Outcome 3: Quality of life

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

What to avoid

Don't group by analysis type when outcomes are analyzed separately:

Results (POOR ORGANIZATION)

Descriptive statistics

Mortality

Hospital readmission

Quality of life

Main analyses

Mortality

Hospital readmission

Quality of life

Sensitivity analyses

Mortality

Hospital readmission

Quality of life

This forces readers to jump back and forth between sections to understand the complete story for any single outcome.

Exception: Shared descriptive statistics

If your descriptive statistics apply to all outcomes (e.g., baseline characteristics in a clinical trial), present them once at the beginning before discussing individual outcomes.